neither the oil itself nor the wealth it created ever touching African soil.

African governments have not found the means or the political will to use mega-projects in mining as the strategic pillar for a broader industrial strategy, part of a plan for diversification, articulation and broadening of the productive base. Mining projects have tended to become simply enclaves, articulated globally but unconnected in the host country. According to Ferguson:

> it is worth noting how such enclaves participate not only in the destruction of national economic spaces but also in the construction of 'global' ones. For just as enclaves of, say, mining production are often fenced off (literally and metaphorically) from their surrounding societies, they are at the same time linked up, with a 'flexibility' that is exemplary of the most up-to-date, 'post-Fordist' neoliberalism, both with giant transnational corporations and with networks of small contractors and subcontractors that span thousands of miles and link nodes across multiple continents … (Ferguson 2006:13).

Viewed from within Mozambique, Carlos Nuno Castel Branco posed the same question in this way:

> A Vale, a SASOL, a Kenmare, a BHP Billiton, an Anadarko, an Artumas etc., etc., generate billions of US dollars each year for their global strategies. Each one of these companies has an annual liquid profit many times higher than the annual budget of Mozambique. For them, Mozambique is a source of resources and profits. This is what we can rationally expect from a multinational company under global capitalism. The question is how can the state and the citizens in our Republic guarantee a rational and sustainable use of these resources in a way that benefits our country and its people, and not just the national and international economic and political elites (Castel Branco 2009:4, my translation).

Vale behind the images

The Brazilian corporations understood to have reached the status of 'global challenger' status, with Vale in the lead, project an image of themselves as a 'motor of development' both in Brazil and in the countries where they invest, generating employment and economic growth, a symbol of 'global Brazil'. This is well documented in a recent study of Brazilian investments in Angola and Mozambique (Garcia, Kato and Fontes 2012).